Plantaris Health AG

Smart insoles for diabetic foot ulcer prevention - Company profile, October 2026

Legal form	AG, founded 2025	**Headquarters**	Zurich
Stage	Seed	**Employees**	6
Product	Plantaris Step (prototype)	**Device class**	IIa (planned)

The problem

Up to a quarter of people with diabetes develop a foot ulcer during their lifetime, and many of these ulcers start from repeated high pressure on parts of the sole that the patient no longer feels because of peripheral neuropathy. Diabetic foot ulcers are a leading cause of lower-limb amputation and cause long and costly hospital stays.

Our product

Plantaris Step is a smart shoe insole for people with diabetes. It contains 16 thin-film pressure sensors, a temperature sensor array and an inertial measurement unit, and streams data to a smartphone app over Bluetooth. Our algorithm detects sustained high plantar pressure and local temperature rises, which precede ulceration, and warns the patient to offload the foot. Gait data (step count, stride variability, balance) are summarised weekly for the treating diabetologist or podiatrist.

We have a working prototype tested on 12 healthy volunteers.

What we are looking for

To move forward we need:

- validation of our plantar pressure and gait measurements against a reference gait laboratory, with experts in foot biomechanics;
- clinical partners in diabetology and diabetic foot care to design and run a pilot study with 60 patients with neuropathy;
- support with machine learning on wearable sensor data, including fall-risk estimation from gait in older patients;
- guidance on the regulatory route as a Class IIa medical device under Swiss MedDO / EU MDR, and help setting up the clinical investigation (ethics submission, monitoring);
- a possible location in the Bern region close to a university hospital, with access to translational medicine and entrepreneurship programmes.

Business model

The insole is sold to diabetes clinics and podiatry practices (hardware plus annual software licence per patient). In a second step we seek reimbursement by Swiss health insurers.

Plantaris Health AG is a fictional company created to test the Research & Expertise Navigator. Any resemblance to a real company is unintended.